Q+A

STEPPING INTO THE SPOTLIGHT

Ananya Panday plays an heiress-turned-hustler in Prime Video's comedy-drama series, *Call Me Bae*



Q. Many may say playing Bae, a fashion forward, privileged Gen Z woman, is totally up Ananya Panday's alley...

It may be in my comfort zone but the character was still a challenge. I feel Bae is on level 100 all the time so I had to constantly keep the energy up. I was also doing comedy for the first time.

Q. Comedies are few and far between in streaming these days...

It was a big reason for doing *Call Me Bae*. Right now, we are seeing a lot of dark content and, while I am a huge fan of that, sometimes you just want to watch something happy and light to feel good.

Q. Carrying the weight of a show on your shoulders must be quite an experience?

It's very gratifying. As a young actress, the fact that Amazon Prime, Dharmatic and Karan [Johar] are backing a female-led show is a huge deal. I hope it's the start of much more, not just for me, but for all young actresses out there. It also gives me a lot more confidence...I don't think after this I can settle for a lesser role.

Q. It's a busy next month for you. After *Call Me Bae*, there's *CTRL* on Netflix in early October. Is this a pivotal moment in your career?

It's an exciting time because even in *CTRL* I am playing a lead character. I want to keep challenging myself. I also want to give the audiences something different. These projects have given me a lot more to do and made me fall in love with the process of acting all over again. ■

with Suhani Singh

Photograph by **ARJUN MARK/ COSMOPOLITAN**
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